



Winding Tree

Simplifying Travel Integrations with Simard Suite of Developer Tools



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Understanding the intricacies of corporate travel interfaces of airlines, and hotels such as shopping, pricing, booking, and payments, often entails unraveling a labyrinthine network of diverse systems and protocols. Key challenges include establishing secure communication channels between suppliers and buyers, accommodating the disparate APIs utilized by airlines, and various methods of payments, and ensuring robust security measures are in place to safeguard transactions.

However, what if there existed a solution to streamline and expedite this entire process for travel companies and startups alike? These were some of the questions and challenges we had in the beginning before we created Simard. Our journey to tackle these issues led us to create the Simard suite of tools developed by Winding Tree, poised to revolutionize the travel industry's technological landscape. By creating these tools we wanted to empower developers and business leaders to efficiently create and integrate travel solutions for free with open-source technology, offering a seamless and expedited approach to innovation in the sector.

The Motivation Behind Simard

Simard facilitates direct connections between travel buyers and sellers, eliminating middlemen and drastically simplifying complex interfaces that travel suppliers use (i.e.NDC)

Simard was one of our strategies to seed Winding Tree marketplace, addressing the challenges of getting users onboard through strategic partnerships. One of such partnerships involved collaborating with TOP corporate travel buyers globally, including those among the top 5 worldwide. By connecting these corporate buyers with suppliers, Simard helped seed the marketplace with suppliers eager to engage directly with major corporate entities.

Another Simard's strategy involved Win.so, an on-chain hotel booking platform, which targeted crypto natives and digital nomads by incentivizing them with exclusive hotel deals. With the Win.so project we were able to save 20,000 Euros for the travelers attending Devconnect conference in Amsterdam in 2022 and it was the first ever on-chain hotel booking with crypto in history. Despite challenges, both strategies aimed to overcome the "chicken and egg" problem inherent in marketplace adoption.

Simard underwent extensive testing iterations, including live trials with one of the top 5 corporate travel buyers. These trials involved connecting with major airline carriers and hotels worldwide. To facilitate these connections, Winding Tree developed tools to normalize and simplify interfaces, which have since been open-sourced to benefit anyone seeking to connect and book travel.

Imagine you're trying to build a booking tool that requires you to connect to airlines and hotel APIs. Currently, you're faced with the daunting task of navigating multiple airline and hotel interfaces, each with its own set of APIs and payment systems. And often a lot of hotels don't even provide an API. This fragmented approach not only consumes valuable time but also increases the risk of errors and delays. You also need to manage payment with credit cards (or in case of corporate customers payment with a

centralized corporate card), deal with security issues related to card payments, etc...

To simplify these intricate processes, Winding Tree is dedicated to promoting competition and democratizing travel. Our free open-source tools provide a substantial advantage for corporate entities, startups, and travel agencies. Whether you're a major corporation or a fledgling startup, these tools streamline the travel booking process, enabling users to connect directly with suppliers and enhancing marketplace competitiveness.

How Simard Works

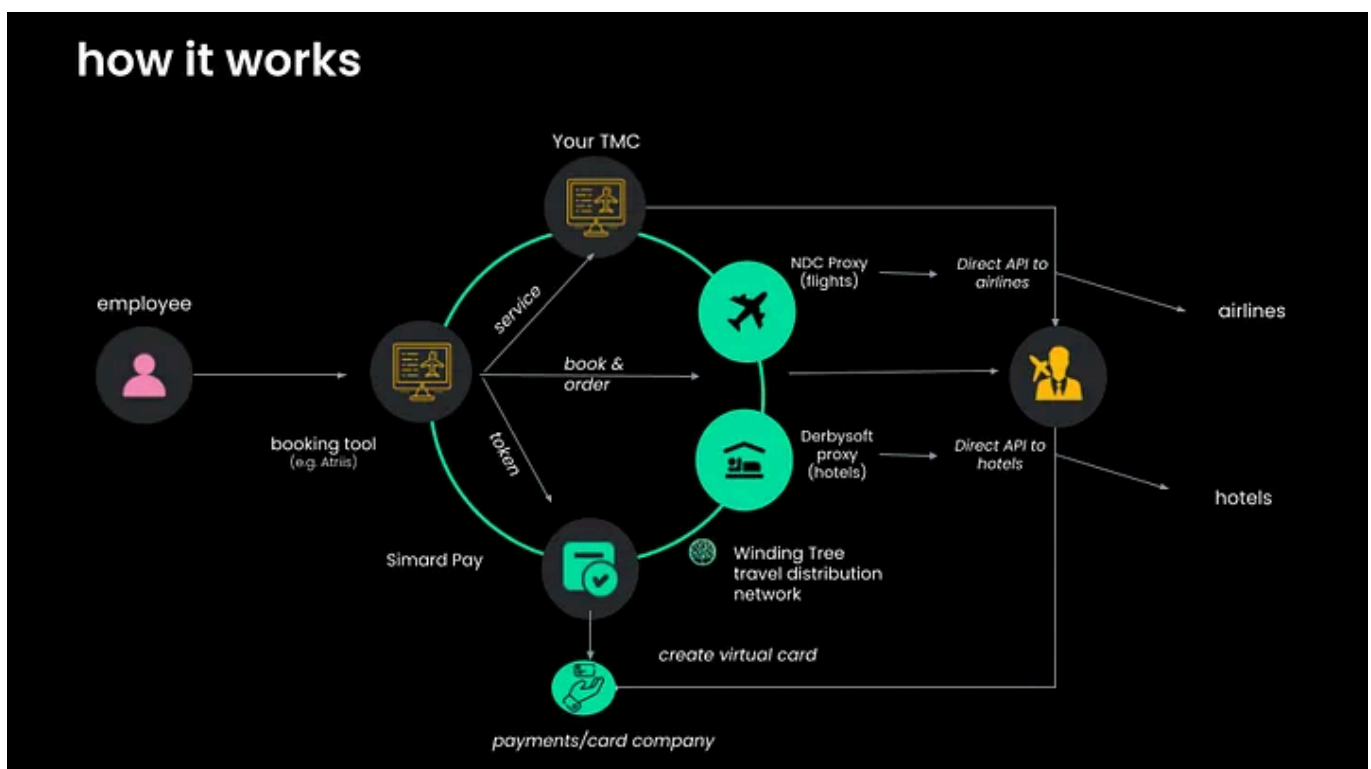
At its core, Simard simplifies the complex web of interactions between buyers, airlines, hotels, and payment systems. Here's a more detailed overview:

- **Verified Profiles:** Both buyers and suppliers have ORGiD profiles with attestations from Winding Tree, establishing trustworthiness within the decentralized network. These profiles serve as digital credentials, verifying the identity and credibility of each party involved.
- **Unified Interface:** Simard acts as a facilitator, allowing buyers to interact with multiple suppliers through a single interface. This eliminates the need to navigate disparate APIs and business logics, streamlining the booking process and reducing friction.
- **Cryptographic Security:** All interactions within the Simard ecosystem are cryptographically signed, ensuring data integrity and linking each transaction to its corresponding profile. This robust security measure enhances trust and transparency, crucial elements in the travel industry.

Solving Common Challenges

Simard tackles several pain points in the travel industry:

- **Diverse APIs:** Airlines often have different APIs, while many hotels don't provide APIs at all. Simard's NDC Proxy and Derbysoft Proxy streamline integration, making it easier for buyers to access a wide range of suppliers without worrying about compatibility issues.
- **Payment Processing:** Suppliers prioritize timely payments, and Simard Pay ensures just that. Its innovative "payment guarantee" feature ensures suppliers receive their dues promptly, boosting trust and reliability in the ecosystem. This not only benefits suppliers but also enhances the overall user experience for buyers.



Decentralization and Future Prospects

While Simard Pay is designed with decentralization in mind, NDC and Derbysoft Proxies are more centralized due to technical limitations. However, Winding Tree envisions a future where decentralized solutions dominate the travel landscape, and Simard serves as a stepping stone towards that goal.

In this future scenario, travel booking becomes more transparent, efficient, and accessible to all parties involved. Decentralized technologies such as

blockchain enable secure peer-to-peer transactions, eliminating the need for intermediaries and reducing costs. Simard plays a crucial role in this transition, laying the groundwork for a more decentralized and inclusive travel ecosystem.

Open Source Contribution

As part of our commitment to fostering innovation and collaboration, we're proud to announce that most of Simard technologies and tools have been open-sourced on GitHub with more things to come in the future. You can access the codebase and contribute to its development [here](#).

Simard represents a significant leap forward in simplifying corporate travel booking. By untangling the complexities of interfaces, APIs, and payments, it empowers buyers to connect with suppliers effortlessly. As technology continues to evolve, Simard paves the way for a more accessible and decentralized future in travel booking, where transparency, trust, and efficiency reign supreme.

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